## The Harbor Survey

The harbor survey began in the spring, when the ice had cleared from the inner channel and the pilots could take the launch out at first light. Each morning the crew measured the depth at forty marked stations, wrote the readings in a bound log, and compared them with the charts drawn twenty years before.

By the middle of summer the pattern was plain. The channel had shifted toward the eastern breakwater, and the shoal off the old ferry landing had grown by almost a meter. The pilots had known this for years from the feel of the boats, but the survey gave them numbers they could show the port council.

The council voted in the autumn to dredge the eastern approach and to move two of the channel buoys. The survey crew stayed on through the winter to check the work, and their final log, bound in green cloth, is kept in the harbor office today.

## Quarterly Rainfall by Station

| Station | Winter | Spring | Summer | Autumn |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| North Ridge | 212 mm | 148 mm | 64 mm | 190 mm |
| Mill Creek | 187 mm | 131 mm | 58 mm | 176 mm |
| Lower Valley | 143 mm | 102 mm | 41 mm | 129 mm |
| Harbor Point | 236 mm | 159 mm | 77 mm | 214 mm |
| Cedar Flats | 98 mm | 86 mm | 35 mm | 91 mm |
| East Summit | 254 mm | 171 mm | 82 mm | 233 mm |

Readings are totals for each quarter, rounded to the nearest millimeter.

# Library Card Application

Full name: Margaret Ellen Doyle

Street address: 41 Orchard Lane

City: Fairhaven

Postal code: 04821

Telephone: 555 0142

Date of birth: 12 March 1987

Card type: Adult

Signed by the applicant on 3 June 2026.

## Notes on Garden Soil

Good garden soil holds water without staying wet. A handful squeezed in the palm should keep its shape for a moment and then crumble when pressed with a thumb.

Clay soil drains slowly and warms late in the spring. Working in leaf mold and coarse sand over several seasons opens it up and lets roots reach deeper.

Sandy soil drains quickly and loses its nutrients in heavy rain. Compost added each autumn gives it body and feeds the worms that keep it loose.

Most vegetables grow best in soil that is slightly acid. A simple test kit from the hardware store shows the level in a few minutes.

Lime raises the level slowly and should go on in the autumn, so the winter rain can carry it down. Sulfur lowers it, but more slowly still.

Whatever the soil, a layer of mulch keeps it cool in summer, holds moisture through dry weeks, and smothers most of the weeds before they start.